PUBLIC BANK

60 YEARS

# GROWTH AND TRUST

**BANK** FOR THE **PEOPLE**

## Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

New Year Message 2026

Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

# NEW YEAR MESSAGE

**My fellow corporate family members,**

As we usher in the year 2026, I extend my heartfelt wishes to every member of the Public Bank family for a blessed and fulfilling New Year. This year holds special significance for all of us, as we celebrate Public Bank's 60th Anniversary. This remarkable milestone stands as a testament to our enduring strength, resilience, and the unshakeable trust we have built over six decades. As we commemorate this significant occasion, I wish to express my most profound appreciation to all members of our corporate family for your hard work, dedication, and unwavering commitment that have driven the Bank's success and growth.

Celebrating 60 Years of Growth and Trust is more than a theme; it is the story of our journey. From our humble beginnings in 1966 to becoming one of Malaysia's most respected financial institutions, our success has been guided by the founding vision of our late Chairman, Tan Sri Dato' Sri Dr. Teh Hong Piow, who believed that integrity, prudence, and professionalism are the cornerstones of lasting growth. These values continue to define us, lighting the way forward even as the world around us changes.

## Honouring a Legacy Built on Trust

Over the decades, we have navigated changing economic landscapes with discipline and foresight. We have remained steadfast in our core values, prioritising customers, upholding sound fundamentals, and fostering a strong performance culture. Through every challenge, our unwavering commitment to excellence, built on trust from our stakeholders, has enabled us to achieve consistent growth and earn the confidence of millions. That is our legacy — one we should all be deeply proud of.

## Taking Pride in Our Shared Journey

As we commemorate this significant milestone, let us take pride in what we have accomplished together, not only in our financial achievements but also in our ongoing contributions to nation-building, sustainable progress, and community well-being. Our collective dedication has strengthened Public Bank's reputation as "A Bank Built on Trust."

Looking ahead, we must continue to embrace innovation, digital transformation, and sustainability as key drivers of our next phase of growth. While the financial landscape evolves rapidly, our guiding principles remain the same. We will continue to serve our customers with integrity, prudence, and professionalism - values that have stood the test of time and will continue to anchor us in the decades to come.

**Together, We Build the Next Chapter**

As we enter a new era, we need to recognise the realities of today's marketplace. Competition is intensifying, and the financial landscape has undergone a significant transformation. New technologies, evolving customer expectations, and shifting market dynamics are transforming our industry at a rapid pace. Our business model must continue to adapt to the emerging needs, or we risk being left behind. As the saying goes, *past success does not guarantee future success.*

We are already seeing the impact of net interest margin compression across the industry. The highly competitive loan and deposit pricings are eroding margins. These challenges are real, and they require us to be agile, forward-looking, and bold in our strategies to protect profitability.

Look no further, non-interest income is the key. The non-interest segment requires no capital cost and is an effective revenue stream to strengthen the Group's buffers against margin compression. Tapping aggressively on our wide array of wealth management and fee-based products, we are well-positioned to build further growth momentum in the non-interest income segment. Time does not wait. If we act now, we can ride the waves of challenges instead of being swamped by them.

Yet, even as we confront the competitive pressures, we must take pride in the fact that Public Bank continues to uphold its strong position, standing firm as number one in many key areas. This is a testament to your hard work, your discipline, and your unwavering commitment to excellence. We will continue to build on this strength as we reinvent, innovate, and sharpen our competitive edge.

At the same time, we must attune ourselves to the evolving needs of our customers. We must respond with agility, innovation, and a heightened commitment to delivering an exceptional customer experience. Only by understanding and meeting customer needs we can sustain our relevance and leadership.

Along this journey, we must also embrace a forward-looking mindset, one that encourages continuous learning, adaptability, and a willingness to explore new approaches to doing things. This mindset will allow us to stay ahead of challenges and seize new opportunities with confidence.

As we progress, we must not forget the unique Public Bank corporate culture and values that have shaped the Group for six decades. These values: integrity, prudence, discipline, and service excellence are the heart of who we are. Our competitive strength is also built on our long-term prudence in cost management. Public Bank has long been upholding its position as the bank with the most efficient cost-income ratio, enabling us to operate efficiently in navigating an environment of rising costs and tightening margins. I urge all staff: do not lose these values; uphold them with pride as we continue our journey forward.

To every member of the Public Bank family, thank you once again for your steadfast dedication and contributions. Your pride in the Bank, your unity, and your care for one another are what truly make us exceptional.

As we celebrate 60 Years of Growth and Trust, let us carry forward our founder's legacy with the same spirit of excellence and purpose. Indeed, the robust foundation and unique, enduring culture of excellence we cherish today are a direct testament to the foresight, unwavering dedication, and core values championed by Tan Sri Dato' Sri Dr. Teh Hong Piow. May this milestone year remind us that when we stay true to his values and to one another, there is no limit to what we can achieve. Together, we will continue to build a stronger, more sustainable future, one where trust remains our greatest strength.

Ultimately, whatever we do, we must never lose the strong corporate culture that defines us. This culture, shaped over six decades, is our greatest intangible asset. It is the quiet strength behind our discipline, our loyalty, our service excellence, and our unity of purpose. In the spirit of "One Team, One Dream," we must continue to uphold and protect this unique identity, ensuring that the values instilled by our founder remain deeply rooted in all that we do. As we evolve, transform, and embrace new ways of working, let us stay anchored in the principles that have made Public Bank a trusted institution for 60 years. Our culture is not merely part of our history; it is the foundation of our future.

Once again, I wish everyone a **Happy New Year 2026.**
May the year ahead bring you and your loved ones continued health, happiness, and success.

**Tan Sri Dato' Sri (Dr) Tay Ah Lek**
Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer
Public Bank Berhad